COMMON CENTS · FINANCIAL FORECAST

Margaret's next 12 months

Retired, living on state and private pension

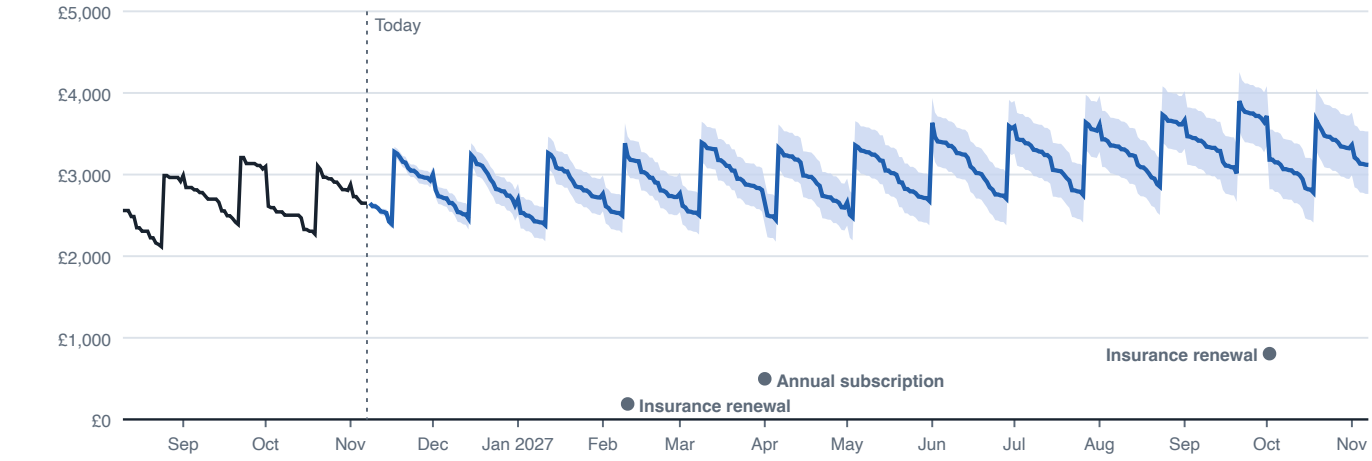
Prepared 07 November 2026
Based on 18 months of transactions
1,000 simulated futures

You could absorb a £500 surprise bill: your lowest expected balance would still be £1,882.

Answer to your biggest worry: Unexpected bills

BALANCE TODAY	IN 30 DAYS	IN 90 DAYS	HARDSHIP RISK
£2,650	£2,653	£2,541	8% LOW
Overdraft limit £0 · savings £14,250	likely £2,546 to £2,771 · High confidence (92%)	likely £2,326 to £2,769 · High confidence (87%)	High confidence · needs more than a £200 buffer to improve

Your balance: last 3 months and next 12 months



Actual balance · Most likely forecast · Likely range (8 in 10 futures fall here)

How to read this: the dark line is what actually happened. The blue line is the most likely path from today; the shaded band shows where your balance lands in 8 out of 10 simulated futures. The wider the band, the less certain the forecast.

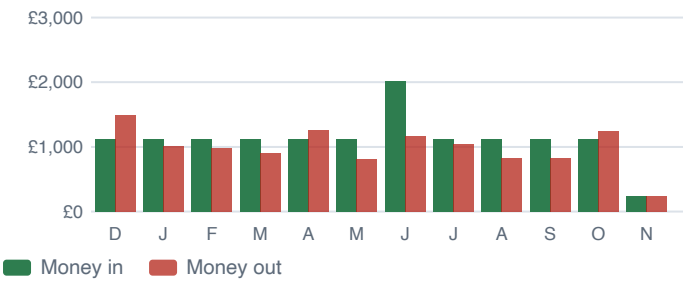
What's driving your risk

No significant risk factors found.

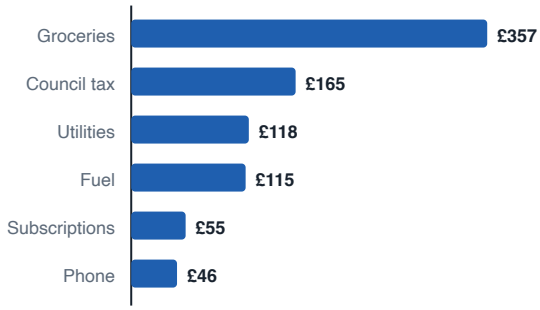
Planned life changes

None planned in the next 12 months.

Income vs spending, last 12 months



Where your money goes (per month)



COMMON CENTS · FINANCIAL FORECAST

What could happen, and what you can do

Margaret · 07 November 2026

Your alerts

RESILIENCE · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Ready for a surprise bill

You are well placed for unexpected bills. If a £500 bill arrived, your lowest balance would still be about £1,882.

Why am I seeing this? Our surprise bill test shows your lowest expected balance would be £1,882. Your usual lowest balance is £2,382.

Try: Keep your savings in an easy-access account so you can reach them quickly if a bill comes.

FORECAST · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Winter and Christmas costs ahead

Your spending usually rises in December. Last year it was about £525 higher than a typical month.

Why am I seeing this? Last December's spending was about £525 above normal. Your energy bills were also about £47 a month higher last winter.

Try: Set aside about £525 in your current account before December to cover the extra costs.

OPPORTUNITY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Your savings could earn more

Your savings of £14,250 earn a low rate. A better easy-access account could earn you about £570 more a year.

Why am I seeing this? Your Instant Access Saver pays 0.5%. Some easy-access accounts pay around 4.5%.

Try: Compare easy-access savings accounts this month and choose one that keeps your money easy to reach.

FORECAST · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Your next bills

British Gas takes £105 on 15 November. Your State Pension of £885 arrives on 17 November.

Why am I seeing this? Your bill calendar also shows BT Broadband for £46 on 20 November and Stockport Council for £165 on 1 December.

Try: Note these dates on your calendar so nothing comes as a surprise.

Written by Claude from the forecast data above.

Stress tests: lowest expected balance



SCENARIO (NEXT 90 DAYS)	BELOW £0	PAST OVERDRAFT
Forecast as is	0%	0%
£500 bill tomorrow	0%	0%
No pay for 2 months	0%	0%

YOUR GOAL: RETIREMENT

Your pension covers your spending each month.

Target: Make income last

Your answers: Retirement · Unexpected bills · No life changes · £500 bill: Savings

COMMON CENTS · FINANCIAL FORECAST

Coming up, and ways to get ahead

Margaret · 07 November 2026

Coming up: bills and spending spikes we expect

WHEN	WHAT	EXPECTED COST	CONFIDENCE	WHY WE THINK SO
December – February	**Winter energy increase**	£128–£170	High	Your energy bills were about £47/month higher last winter than in summer
December 2026	**Seasonal spending increase**	£420–£630	High	Your December spending was about £525 higher than a typical month last year
27 Jan – 24 Feb 2027	**Insurance renewal** RAC Breakdown	£127–£155	Medium	You paid RAC Breakdown £128 around this time last year; costs in this category are rising about 8% a year
18 Mar – 15 Apr 2027	**Annual subscription** TV Licensing	£166–£202	Medium	You paid TV Licensing £174 around this time last year
April 2027	**Seasonal spending increase**	£129–£194	High	Your April spending was about £162 higher than a typical month last year
18 Sep – 16 Oct 2027	**Insurance renewal** Direct Line Home Insurance	£336–£409	High	You paid Direct Line Home Insurance £338 around this time last year; costs in this category are rising about 8% a year

Opportunities

OPPORTUNITY	BENEFIT	SUGGESTED ACTION	CONFIDENCE
Savings earning a low interest rate ★ your goal £14,250 is earning 0.5%	£570/yr	Compare easy-access accounts paying around 4.5%	High
Review subscriptions Subscriptions cost you about £55 a month	£197/yr	Check which subscriptions you still use	Medium

How this forecast was made. We found your regular income and bills from payment patterns, then simulated 1,000 possible futures, drawing day-to-day spending from your own history with seasonal effects (for example Christmas) and inflation. Risk scores combine the forecast with trends in your overdraft use, savings, income and bills; every factor is listed above. Economic figures and life-event costs are estimates and are listed in the data.

COMMON CENTS · FINANCIAL FORECAST

Your plan

Margaret · 07 November 2026

Smallest changes with the biggest effect

Your forecast looks healthy. No changes needed to stay on track.

Greedy search over 1,000 simulated futures: each round adds the change with the biggest risk reduction per unit of effort.

SAFE TO SPEND

£277 a day

You have plenty of room: your usual £15 a day is well covered until 17 Nov, with an 80% chance of staying above £0.

Next few days of bills and income

DATE	WHO	AMOUNT	BALANCE AFTER
Sun 15 Nov	British Gas	–£105	£2,425
Tue 17 Nov	DWP State Pension	+£885	£3,278
Fri 20 Nov	BT Broadband	–£46	£3,157
Sun 22 Nov	British Heart Foundation	–£20	£3,080
Sun 22 Nov	Sky TV	–£45	£3,080
Tue 01 Dec	Aviva Pension	+£240	£3,002
Tue 01 Dec	Stockport Council	–£165	£3,002

Spending patterns we noticed

- Nothing unusual.

For your stage of life (retired)

- Check whether you could get Pension Credit: many eligible people don't claim it, and it unlocks other help.
- Keep easy-access savings for bills, and compare rates on larger savings.

Support you asked for

I prefer simple explanations (you asked)

Short sentences, fewer numbers, no jargon.

Support preferences only change how information is shown. They are never used in any score or shared.

HOW ACCURATE IS THIS FORECAST?

Tested on 3 past periods: average error £82 vs £252 for the best simple guess (68% better). The 80% range contained the real balance 73% of the time.

We re-ran the model as if it were 60, 90, 120 days ago and compared it with what really happened. Measured on the demo data, which is synthetic.